

Diego Hernandez

PhD Candidate in Political Science

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I study why some people refuse a partisan label, and how that refusal translates into political behavior. My research brings the methods of political psychology to understand a group that most accounts of partisanship treat as a residual category: the American independent.

EDUCATION

PhD, Political Science 2023–2028

Stony Brook University · Committee: Leonie Huddy, Stephanie DeMora, Pazit Ben Nun-Bloom, Eric Groenendyk
Advanced to candidacy, July 2026

MA, Political Science 2022–2023

Stony Brook University · Advisor: Gallya Lahav
Democratic Governance, Interpersonal Trust, and Interpersonal Responsibility: Do Values Predict Vote Choice in Hypothetical EU Membership Referenda?

MSc, Culture and Conflict in a Global Europe 2020–2021

The London School of Economics and Political Science (LSE) · Advisor: Cristóbal Garibay-Petersen
Searching For Uniqueness in the Crowd: Conspiracies and their Believers

BA, Politics 2018–2020

University of California, Santa Cruz

AA, Political Science; Liberal Arts: Social and Behavioral Sciences; Liberal Arts: Arts and Humanities

Santa Barbara City College

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Instructor of Record 2026–

Political Science Department, Stony Brook University, Stony Brook, NY

Graduate Assistant/Research Assistant 2025–

Political Science Department, Stony Brook University, Stony Brook, NY

Teaching Assistant 2024

Political Science Department, Stony Brook University, Stony Brook, NY

Counselor to the Dean of Social Sciences 2019–2020

University of California, Santa Cruz, Santa Cruz, CA

Guest Lecturer 2015–2018

Santa Barbara City College, Santa Barbara, CA

TEACHING

FELLOWSHIPS, AWARDS & GRANTS

Upper Second Class Honors The London School of Economics and Political Science	2021
University Grant University of California, Santa Cruz	2019-2020
Dean's List University of California, Santa Cruz	2020
Academic Honors Santa Barbara City College	2019

METHODS & SKILLS

Methods	Quantitative social science, data analysis in R, Python, and SPSS programming languages, social science experiments, Qualtrics; qualitative methods including focus groups and interviews, text-as-data approaches
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